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Top Skills

Cloud Computing
Data Privacy
Agile

Certifications

Worldwide Software Architecture
Summit 22 vol.2
Professional Scrum Master™ I (PSM
I)
Professional Agile Leadership™ I
(PAL I)
Unit testing
Essential Management Skills

Honors-Awards

TOP 1% (SVI)

Publications

Actionable Marketing Tips for CTOs
and Tech Decision-Makers
CTO as a Service – Your
Technology Strategy in the hands of
Experts
A journey into the Rust programming
language
How ChatGPT works and AI, ML &
NLP Fundamentals
PentaBar Webinar - AI LLMs for
Operational Efficiency

Alexandru Hutanu

Principal Engineering Manager at Microsoft Azure Core (Cloud+AI) |
Technology Leader | Agile Leader | GenAIOps
Bucharest, Bucharest, Romania

Summary

I am a results-driven seasoned engineering leader with a strong technical background in software engineering and architecture, a passion for innovation, and a track record of delivering complex, scalable, resilient, and secure solutions, to businesses and customers, that align with business goals and industry standards, through effective team management, technical excellence, and strategic thinking.

I possess strong communication and interpersonal skills, which enable me to work effectively with stakeholders, communicate complex technical concepts to non-technical audiences, and mentor and motivate team members to achieve their full potential.

I have experience leading teams through all stages of the software development lifecycle, from initial concept to final product delivery and production operations, and have a proven track record of achieving successful outcomes in challenging environments.

Experience

Microsoft

Principal Software Engineering Manager
April 2025 - Present (3 months)
Bucharest Metropolitan Area

Amazon

Software Development Manager
April 2024 - March 2025 (1 year)
Bucharest Metropolitan Area

Software Development Manager 3 (SDM 3, L6) at Amazon, inside Amazon Privacy Services (APS) organization, leading a high-performing engineering team responsible for delivering critical privacy software systems from design

through deployment, owning software architecture with considerable business impact, driving both tactical execution and strategic vision.

I lead with empathy to create an inclusive environment where engineers collaborate on innovative solutions to complex problems. I am accountable for team structure, technical direction, and product roadmaps with a 1-3 year horizon. I partner effectively with stakeholders across the organization to align priorities and overcome challenges.

My responsibilities include:

- Translating business problems into technical strategies and executable roadmaps
- Building and developing diverse engineering talent across multiple experience levels
- Making high-quality architectural and feature decisions that balance customer needs, operational excellence, and business goals
- Creating mechanisms that measure team performance and continuously improve delivery quality
- Working backward from customer problems to define meaningful team goals
- Driving constructive technical discussions and ensuring systems meet Amazon's high standards

I foster an environment where engineers are empowered to innovate while delivering consistently excellent results that delight our customers.

Pentalog

2 years 9 months

Engineering Manager

January 2022 - March 2024 (2 years 3 months)

Bucharest Metropolitan Area

- Working as part of Pentalog's Technology Leadership in the Technology Office, wearing many hats such as: Engineering Manager, CTO As A Service, Senior Technology Consultant or AI Solutions Architect
- Improving overall processes and practices in the company
- Conducting consultancy, management, architecture and various other kinds of technical missions for Pentalog's clients, Pentalog's Technology Office or any other team in Pentalog
- Supporting any teams or projects in Pentalog as part of the Technology Office
- Acting as a 'CTO as a Service' for Pentalog's clients

- Conducting CTO Assessments and CTO Mentoring missions
- Auditor for Technology Audits and Due Diligence missions
- Assessor/Evaluator for Engineering Manager & CTO profiles
- Leading the "Migration Governance" service in Pentalog
- Ranked in TOP1 of top talent rankings using Pentalog's SVI (SkillValue Insight) system
- Leading the AI Engineering in Pentalog since 2022 & main AI Architect/Consultant on all client-facing AI missions in Pentalog

Solutions Architect

July 2021 - January 2022 (7 months)

Bucharest Metropolitan Area

- Working as part of the Technology Office in Pentalog
- Improving overall processes and practices in the company
- Conducting consultancy, management, architecture and various other kinds of technical missions for Pentalog's clients, Pentalog's Technology Office or any other team in Pentalog
- Supporting any teams or projects in Pentalog as part of Technology Office
- Offering the role of 'CTO as a Service' for Pentalog's clients
- Assessor/Evaluator for Dev/SM/PM/CM/PO/DBA/QA roles.

ENSYSCO

4 years 6 months

Chief Technology Officer

October 2019 - July 2021 (1 year 10 months)

Bucharest, Romania

Managing international IT Software Development & IT Infrastructure departments of the company in all sites (about 40 employees)

Head Of Software Development

April 2018 - October 2019 (1 year 7 months)

Bucharest, Romania

- Engineering Manager, Software Architect, IT Site Director, Symfony PHP Developer & DevOps Engineer
- Building web applications & platforms for the energy market
- Building a multi-purpose platform with the energy market in mind but applicable to all industries
- Managing all staff, processes and activities of all the teams of a multinational Software Development department (Multiple Backend & Frontend Development teams, DevOps, QA, Project Management, Product Management)

Tools:

- Agile (Scrum & Kanban) Project Management using Jira
- GIT Source Control with BitBucket, internal private packages repositories with Satis
- Backend Dev: PHP with the Symfony Framework (4.3, 3.4, 2.8), API Platform (2.x)
- Frontend Dev: React & Backbone
- DevOps: Docker, Jenkins, Ansible, Puppet
- QA: Java (Selenium) & PHP (Codeception)

Software Development Team Lead

February 2017 - April 2018 (1 year 3 months)

Bucharest, Romania

- Symfony PHP Developer, DevOps Engineer, Software Architect & Team Lead for B2B platforms developed for the energy & gas markets, built using backend PHP frameworks such as Symfony & Oro (based on Symfony) and frontend JS frameworks (react);
- Building & Leading teams of both Backend Developers (Symfony, Oro) & Frontend Developers (React, extJS, Backbone) as well as QA Automation Engineers;
- Established and implemented a proper Software Development Lifecycle (Agile using Scrum & Kanban) with proper software management tools (Jira, Git, etc)
- Implemented and maintained software development tools (Jenkins, Docker, Puppet, etc)
- Enforced software development processes and best practices (Coding standards, coding guidelines & best practices, code reviews, testing, etc)

Fashion Days Group

2 years 7 months

Software Developer

April 2016 - January 2017 (10 months)

Bucharest, Romania

PHP Developer for Business Tools. Building internal tools used by the company (e.g. site management tool, customer management tool) as well as worked on the main web shop.

Worked mainly on backend projects, but also on Full Stack & DevOps projects.

Main responsibilities:

Building PHP applications using PHP based frameworks (or others if they fit better in the project's' scope).

Developing advanced database driven applications & systems (including eCommerce)

Working inside a SDLC which applies Agile, Kanban & Scrum principles.

Documented features. Written technical specifications & infrastructure requirements. Created pull requests and code reviews whenever possible.

Working with a multi-disciplinary team to convert business needs into technical specifications, then implement them.

Programming Languages & Frameworks:

Strong knowledge of PHP (OOP & procedural). Knowledge of Javascript, Groovy, Scala, Ruby.

Strong Knowledge of Symfony Full Stack & Symfony Components, as well as Silex. Knowledge of React, Bootstrap, jQuery.

Data manipulation:

Strong knowledge of SQL (MySQL, sqlite). Knowledge of noSQL (Couchbase).

Knowledge of ORM (Doctrine).

Knowledge of XML & XSLT, JSON & JSON Schemas, CSV, YML & various other data serialization formats.

Knowledge with caching systems (Memcached)

Knowledge of Regular Expressions.

Worked with AD via LDAP.

Source control:

Strong knowledge of GIT

Software Automation (DevOps projects):

Implemented Continuous Integration / Continuous Delivery with Jenkins

Strong knowledge of Vagrant. Knowledge of Docker.

Knowledge of Puppet (also written puppet modules)

Knowledge of ANT

Code Quality:

Strong knowledge of PHPUnit, Codeception (unit & functional tests).

Knowledge of Gatling (performance testing).

Always working with PHPCS & PHPMD (Coding Standards, Naming Conventions, Code Complexity Rules, etc)

OS:

Strong Knowledge of Unix systems (Linux & MacOS). Familiar with Windows.

Software Development Engineer in Test

July 2014 - April 2016 (1 year 10 months)

Bucharest, Romania

- Developed all types of automation tests using the Codeception PHP testing framework, including API tests, Acceptance (GUI) Tests, Functional Tests (Db, CLI - backend tests), etc
- Worked on several projects on both the main application (from front-end pixel-perfect testing to back-end testing on bash scripts, cronjobs, ETL, database testing, log monitoring and debugging etc.), business tools (Site management tools, Customer management tools, etc) and ERP tools;
- Followed all testing standards within a Agile/Scrum software development methodology; Applied most testing types under this SDLC, including (but not limited to): Automation Testing, Database testing, Compatibility testing, Smoke testing, Sanity testing, Regression testing, Retesting, Acceptance Testing, Usability testing, Security testing, Performance testing;
- All projects passed through all necessary QA-related testing phases, thoroughly checking them against the requirements during the System testing phase and requesting specifically an UAT at the end of each project (during Acceptance Testing, where necessary);
- Analyzed the impact of any given project (including checking the git diffs where possible) as well as thoroughly analyzing all project documentation to prepare the best and most efficient testing approach
- Ensured the delivery of all assigned projects with top quality under the given time;
- Documented and created test cases and test plans for all projects under testing whenever time permitted;
- Worked unsupervised, gathered all required information to start any project (by initiating discussions with both the dev teams, and the product owners to ensure that everything is properly understood right from the start)

Printec Group

QA Team Lead

February 2014 - July 2014 (6 months)

- Managed all QA members and activities and coordinated all related tasks of the assigned projects.
- Ensured the quality of the project deliverables and controls of the managed projects.

- Conduct the prioritization meeting along with the business management team.
- Kept track of progress on all projects and prepare status reports for the Management and/or Business Owners/Project Sponsors.
- Ensured the projects run on scope, time, cost and resources approved.
- Complete work breakdown structure for the estimation of efforts needed for each task.
- Resolved issues and solve problems throughout the project cycle.
- Prepare or help with the project documentation
- Actively monitor progress against the plan, resolving issues and initiating corrective actions as appropriate.
- Capture and publish lessons learnt.
- Propose management interventions wherever gaps in the project are identified.
- Act as an IT Consultant towards the business management team within the scope of the managed projects.
- Organized and kept track of business Change requests lists.
- Defined and kept track of internal defined requirements; define and assign tasks on different projects.
- Communicate with our clients to ensure the requirements are clearly defined;
- Explained to clients the process of collecting and managing requirements.
- Participated in and contributing during conceptual brainstorming sessions.
- Challenged and proposed ways to continuously improve working methods, systems and processes as part of the IT team.

Atypical Games s.r.l. (formerly Revo Solutions s.r.l.)

1 year 9 months

QA Project Manager

November 2013 - February 2014 (4 months)

- Managed up to 11 projects, assuring that all resources are properly met and efficiently allocated;
- Supervised all testing staff and activities
- Provided direction and assigned tasks to the test team
- Reviewed the logical & physical game design docs
- Created and updated testing guidelines
- Developed test plans; created manual and automated logical excel checklists
- Defined test processes including required test activities and deliverables
- Ensured all testing standards (functionality, compliance, company internal) are being met
- Provided support for the test team in regards to questions concerning GDDs

- Reviewed all the issues and defects reported by testers
- Ensured that all aspects of the testing process were covered
- Maintained full time communication with the dev team regarding all aspects of the project
- Provided game improvement feedback
- Provided daily and weekly status reports to the dev team

QA Project Lead

February 2013 - November 2013 (10 months)

- Managed QA teams made up of up to 14 staff members
- Provided training for new testers
- Trained one QA Project Lead Assistant
- Supervised all testing staff and activities
- Provided direction and assigned tasks to the test team
- Reviewed the logical & physical game design docs
- Created and updated testing guidelines
- Developed test plans; created manual and automated logical excel checklists
- Defined test processes including required test activities and deliverables
- Ensured all testing standards (functionality, compliance, company internal) are being met
- Provided support for the test team in regards to questions concerning GDDs
- Reviewed all the issues and defects reported by testers
- Ensured that all aspects of the testing process were covered
- Maintained full time communication with the dev team regarding all aspects of the project
- Provided game improvement feedback
- Provided daily and weekly status reports to the dev team

QA Project Lead Assistant

December 2012 - February 2013 (3 months)

- Followed all testing standards
- Assisted the Project Lead on all requests
- Provided the Project Lead with input for status report
- Cooperated with the Project Lead to create test plans and cases
- Managed groups of testers in covering daily/weekly tasks
- Created excel test cases
- Participated and conducted walk-through of the test plans and cases
- Reviewed the logical & physical game design docs
- Provided game improvement feedback
- Provided daily reports

QA Tester

June 2012 - November 2012 (6 months)

- Followed all testing standards
- Participated and conducted walkthrough of the test plans and cases
- Reviewed the logical & physical game design docs
- Provided game improvement feedback
- Provided daily reports

Atypical Games s.r.l. (formerly Revo Solutions s.r.l.)

QA Tester

July 2011 - September 2011 (3 months)

- Followed all testing standards
 - Participated and conducted walkthrough of the test plans and cases
 - Reviewed the logical & physical game design docs
 - Provided game improvement feedback
 - Provided daily reports
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